

The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called the Compendium of All Knowledge

Ārya Sarva Vidyā Saṃgraha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra · Toh 227 · Derge Kangyur

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Toh 227 in the Kangyur is a Mahāyāna sūtra known in English as The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called the Compendium of All Knowledge, in Sanskrit as the Ārya Sarva Vidyā Saṃgraha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra, and in Tibetan as Phags pa rnam par 'thag pa. It belongs to the sūtra division of the Kangyur and presents itself as a discourse delivered by the Buddha on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, set dramatically at the time of his approaching final nirvāṇa, in the presence of a vast assembly of monks, bodhisattvas, gods, and laypeople. As its title suggests, the text is concerned with the gathering or synthesis of knowledge, situating this theme within the solemn context of the Buddha's last rains retreat and his imminent passing.

Translated and edited by the translation committee, and revised with new terminology, definitively established.

In the Indian language: Ārya Sarva Vidyā Saṃgraha Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra.

In the Tibetan language: The Noble Sūtra of the Great Vehicle Called the Compendium of All Knowledge.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear. At one time the Blessed One was dwelling on Vulture Peak Mountain at Rājagṛha, together with a great Saṅgha of sixty-two thousand monks, with eight hundred million bodhisattvas, with sixty thousand gods, and with many thousands of laymen. At that time the hour of the Blessed One's final passing into nirvāṇa had arrived. This was the last occasion on which the Blessed One spent the rains retreat and dwelt at Rājagṛha.

Then the Blessed One entered into a meditative absorption of such a kind that this great trichiliocosm — the world system of the triple thousandfold universe — became adorned with silken streamers and banners, adorned with bowls of perfume and filled with fragrant incense, overflowing with scattered blossoms, and covered over with lotuses bearing a hundred thousand petals each. Into such a meditative absorption he settled.

Within this great trichiliocosm, however many Brahmās (Skt. Brahmā) there were in number — each one alone attended by retinues of tens of millions of followers — all of them proceeded to where the Blessed One was, approached him, bowed their heads to his feet, joined their palms together, paid homage to the Blessed One, and took their places to one side.

Likewise, all the lords of the sons of the gods of the Pure Abodes, all the lords who are sovereign sons of the gods, all the great lords, all the lords of the gods, all the lords of the nāgas, all the lords of the yakṣas, all the lords of the asuras, all the lords of the garuḍas (Skt. garuḍa), all the lords of the kinnaras (Skt. kinnara), and all the lords of the great mahoragas (Skt. mahoraga) — however many there were in this great trichiliocosm — each attended by retinues of many hundreds of thousands of millions, all proceeded to where the Blessed One was, approached him, bowed their heads to his feet, joined their palms together, paid homage to the Blessed One, and took their places to one side.

In the world systems of the ten directions, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, however many there were of the great bodhisattvas (Skt. mahāsattva) who are of great renown and great power — all of them likewise proceeded to where the Blessed One was, approached him, bowed their heads to his feet, joined their palms together, paid homage to the Blessed One, and took their places to one side.

At that time, in this great trichiliocosm — from the summit of existence down — not even a space the breadth of the tip of a staff remained that was not filled with powerful and renowned beings: gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas (Skt. gandharva), asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, and great mahoragas.

Then the Blessed One, while abiding in knowing awareness, arose from that meditative absorption. Having arisen, he gazed upon the assembly three times. Having gazed upon the assembly, he performed a great lion's roar three times. Having performed the lion's roar, he extended his wondrous tongue three times. Having extended his wondrous tongue three times, he caused the great trichiliocosm to be pervaded by that wondrous tongue three times.

Having thus pervaded the great trichiliocosm with his wondrous tongue three times, and having pervaded it with that miraculous display, he gazed out once more upon the assembly.

Then the entire retinue rose from their seats, joined their palms together, paid homage to the Blessed One himself, and sat back down.

The Blessed One then spoke to the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya: "Unconquerable One, the Tathāgata will pass into complete nirvāṇa before long. This is now the time for you to ask the Tathāgata about the Dharma. This is the occasion. Those among you who have any doubt about the Dharma — if you do not ask the Tathāgata now, you may later come to regret it, thinking: 'How could we have failed to ask while the Tathāgata was present in person?'"

When he had spoken these words, the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, you yourself are the wise one. Blessed One, you yourself know the time, know the occasion, know what is fitting. Blessed One, you who know all and see all, who have penetrated and understood all phenomena — please teach the Dharma in such a way that the manner of the Dharma of all perfectly and completely awakened buddhas may long endure. Please teach the Dharma well in just such a way."

Then the divine son Maheśvara (the great lord among the gods of the Pure Abodes), accompanied by a retinue of eight hundred million divine sons of that same divine realm, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, joined his palms together, and addressed the Blessed One thus: "Blessed One, this Dharma teaching called 'The Compendium of All Weavings' — when the previous Tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly and completely awakened buddhas proclaimed it of old, it brought healing to many beings and happiness to many beings. For the sake of that same teaching of the Tathāgata enduring long, may the Blessed One likewise teach it."

Having made this request, the Blessed One remained silent and by that silence gave his consent to the divine son Maheśvara.

The divine son Maheśvara, understanding from the Blessed One's silence that consent had been granted, withdrew to one side.

Then the Blessed One addressed the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya, and declared: "Unconquerable One, any Tathāgata, arhat, perfectly and completely awakened buddha of the past who did not teach this Dharma teaching — the sūtra called 'The Compendium of All Weavings' — is no longer present. And in the future, any Tathāgata who shall arise and not teach this Dharma teaching will simply not arise. Why is this? Because one who teaches the Dharma without having trained in this teaching slanders the Tathāgata, abandons the Dharma, and disparages the Saṅgha. Whoever has gone astray with respect to the Three Jewels — that person I declare to be one bound for the lower realms, bound for hell.

"Therefore, Maitreya, those sons and daughters of good family who have genuinely entered upon awakening and who wish to have no confusion regarding me — they should first thoroughly understand and internalize this Dharma teaching, and only then teach the Dharma. Maitreya, in the time to come, the gathering together of this sacred Dharma is your task — be diligent in this."

The bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya replied to the Blessed One: "So be it, Blessed One. I shall listen in accordance with the Blessed One's word."

Then once again the Blessed One called out to the bodhisattva, the great being, Maitreya and declared: "Unconquerable One, on the very night when the Tathāgata achieved manifest and complete unsurpassable perfect awakening,

Maitreya, from that very night when the Tathāgata attained manifest and complete unsurpassable perfect awakening, until the night when the Tathāgata passes into nirvāṇa without remainder — was there anything whatsoever in which the Tathāgata erred, or babbled, or spoke carelessly, or spoke with ill intent, or acted inappropriately in his enlightened activity?"

Maitreya replied: "Blessed One, there was not."

The Blessed One declared: "Unconquerable One, everything whatsoever that the Tathāgata spoke — from the night when the Tathāgata manifestly and completely awakened to unsurpassable perfect awakening, up to the night when the Tathāgata passes into nirvāṇa without remainder — all of that is true, real, just as it is, unerring, and nothing other than what it is. In this regard, certain foolish people who neither know nor have understood the Tathāgata's skillful means take to carping at my plain words, saying: 'This is admissible,' and 'This is inadmissible.' Such as these are those who reject the sacred Dharma. Such as these are those who slander the Tathāgata. For that reason I declare them to be hell-beings.

Unconquerable One, in the future, in the last era of the final five hundred years to come, there will arise monks, nuns, laymen, and laywomen who claim to be bodhisattvas, who were formerly tīrthikas (non-Buddhists), who by the power of their aspirations have gone forth into the well-proclaimed Dharma and Vinaya of the Tathāgata's teaching, who dwell in one-sided conduct, who are harmful to their companions, who are attached to gain and honor, who are miserly toward their households, who disparage their households, who are

ugly in appearance, who delight in inferior things, whose counsel brings no ease, who are obscure, who are of low birth, who are utterly attached to material goods, who are entirely bereft of all the food of dwelling in ease through the Dharma, who are very far removed and completely distant from the food of meditative absorption — those who dwell in deceit and duplicity, who say one thing and do another. Though knowing nothing, they say: "We are possessed of knowledge." Though utterly without learning, they say: "We are learned." They say: "Dwelling in equanimity toward all sentient beings, through great compassion and skillful means, resting in the unforgetful power of the Tathāgata, we teach awakening to all sentient beings in accordance with their dispositions." Some of those same people then say: "One should not train in those sūtras taught for śrāvakas. One should not listen to them. They are not our Dharma — they belong to the śrāvakas, and so bodhisattvas should not train in them. One should not train in those sūtras taught for pratyekabuddhas. One should not listen to them. They are not our Dharma — they belong to the pratyekabuddhas, and so bodhisattvas should not train in them." Such words will arise.

Unconquerable One, as for me — I have taught the Dharma to the gods and tamed them in accordance with their dispositions. In the same way I have taught the Dharma to nāgas, yakṣas, asuras, garuḍas, kiṃnaras, great serpents, gandharvas, and human beings, and tamed each of them in accordance with their dispositions. Unconquerable One, were I to travel to world-realms in the ten directions as numerous as the grains of sand of the Ganges for the sake of benefiting sentient beings, and there too teach the Dharma to sentient beings in accordance with their dispositions — even then those people who claim to be bodhisattvas, those wild and arrogant so-called bodhisattvas, those who slander bodhisattvas,

those who speak falsely, those of little learning — these individuals, without being properly distinguished by my two awakenings, speak of this as two things: "In this a bodhisattva should train; in this a bodhisattva should not train." With that mind they denigrate the Tathāgata, they abandon the Dharma, and they disparage the Saṅgha. When their bodies perish, they will be reborn in the hells. There, after many aeons and many hundreds of aeons have passed, they will attain liberation — and then they will be reborn in a lineage of poverty. When in a hundred times and a hundred more times they would have received a prophecy of awakening, it will instead be that in the age of the five degenerations they will receive that prophecy. For example, it

is just as I myself, having long postponed it through delay, finally achieved perfect and complete awakening in this degenerate age. Those who listen to the words of those people, or act as they do, or think to trust them — they too will go along in just that way: drawn by attachment to evil companions, they will proceed in exactly that direction.

Unconquerable One, in the distant past, in a time beyond innumerable and ever more innumerable aeons, there appeared in this world a Tathāgata, a Worthy One, a fully and perfectly awakened buddha whose name was Renowned Arising from the Rays of Stainless Light. He taught the Dharma to sentient beings for eighty trillion years. Among his scriptural collections there arose a monk named Completely Pure in Livelihood — a Dharma teacher, a speaker of varied discourses, one who correctly taught the multitude, who properly led the multitude to take things up, who properly praised the multitude, and who properly gladdened the multitude. Then the Tathāgata Renowned Arising from the Rays of Stainless Light entrusted to him the preservation of the sacred Dharma in the final time, in the final age. After the parinirvāṇa of that Tathāgata, for ten million years Completely Pure in Livelihood maintained the form of the sacred Dharma. Entering into this Dharma category that gathers together all the weaving, he taught the Dharma, teaching sentient beings in accordance with each one's disposition. He gladdened sentient beings throughout eight hundred thousand cities in accordance with his aspirational prayers, and then he went to the great city called Excellent, where he taught the Dharma in accordance with the dispositions of eighty trillion households, and from that city he established eighty trillion living beings in firm faith. Of those, one trillion were set on the path to unsurpassed awakening. Seventy-nine trillion sentient beings were set on the path of the śrāvakas and tamed.

After that, the monk Completely Pure in Livelihood, together with ten thousand monks, traveled about going to the place of the heart of awakening. Unconquerable One, not long after Completely Pure in Livelihood had departed, there came to that great city Excellent a monk named Dharma, who grasped one thousand sūtras of the weaving. He also attained the four meditative concentrations. As for Completely Pure in Livelihood, he grasped ten trillion sūtra collections and sixty thousand sūtras of the weaving.

Now the monk Dharma, teaching the Dharma in that great city Excellent by means of only one approach, did gladden the people, yet he was not skilled in teaching the Dharma in accordance with each person's individual disposition.

He set forth emptiness to those people with the pronouncement "all phenomena are empty," following after emptiness and continuing to expound by means of emptiness, saying: "This teaching of mine that all phenomena are empty is the authentic word of the Tathāgata alone. What Completely Pure in Livelihood has said is flawed."

"If that monk does not have completely pure livelihood, why is that monk called by the name Completely Pure in Livelihood? His livelihood is not completely pure. Why is that? Because he accepts and receives flowers and makes full use of them. He accepts and receives perfumes and unguents and makes full use of them. He is not one who knows; he is a childish person. I have practiced the holy life for a long time, whereas he is newly ordained — he has not been long since his full ordination, so do not place such trust in him." That monk was indeed heedless, and since the people had deep faith in the monk Completely Pure in Livelihood, when that monk tried to create division among those people, he was unable to divide them.

Then the monk Dharma came to the time of his death, and upon dying, because he had slandered the Tathāgata in such a manner and had abandoned the Dharma in such a manner, he was born in the hells for seventy aeons. When those seventy aeons had passed, for sixty aeons he lost the awakening mind. When those sixty aeons had passed, the Tathāgata Pervading with the Light of Precious Fragrance caused him to generate the mind set upon awakening in that Tathāgata's scriptural collection, and he generated the mind set upon awakening. For nine hundred lifetimes he was born in the animal realm. For six hundred lifetimes he was born among destitute human beings, and throughout all of those he was born without a tongue.

The monk Completely Pure in Livelihood taught the Dharma in the presence of five hundred trillion buddhas, and throughout all of those he was endowed with the five superknowledges. He was worthy of being invited by those blessed buddha-bhagavāns. He also came to teach the Dharma with complete purity in all phenomena. O Ajita, if you think that at that time and in that age the monk called Completely Pure in Livelihood was someone else, you should not view it that way. The one called the Tathāgata Amitābha — at that time and in that age he was the Dharma-teaching monk called Completely Pure in Livelihood.

O Ajita, if you think that at that time and in that age the monk called Dharma was someone else, you should not view it that way. At that time and in that age I myself was the monk called Dharma. Such improper conduct as that arose from none other than myself.

O Ajita, the karmic obscuration that causes one to be impoverished of Dharma is difficult to know in just this way. Through the karmic maturation of that action, I have attained full and perfect awakening in the age of the five degenerations. O Ajita, those bodhisattvas who create division and teach the Dharma — through the karmic maturation of that action they will attain full and perfect awakening in the age of degeneration, yet in their buddha-fields, while awakening and teaching the Dharma, many māras and obstacles will arise for them.

Then the entire retinue shed tears and wept, and cried out these words: "From this day forward, may no one teach the Dharma in the manner that the monk Dharma spoke!" At that moment the great bodhisattvas gathered in that retinue also rose from their seats and prostrated themselves on the ground. Having prostrated themselves on the ground, they wept.

Then the Blessed One, fully knowing, addressed those bodhisattvas with these words: "Noble sons, why do you prostrate yourselves on the ground and weep?" They replied: "Blessed One, we ourselves have seen that we are endowed with that very karmic obscuration." The Blessed One declared: "Noble sons, that is so. After the Tathāgata Dīpaṃkara (Lamp-Maker) had passed into nirvāṇa, there appeared in his scriptural collection a Dharma-teacher named Accumulated Wisdom, and you reviled him,

"From that time forward you never saw a buddha. You never found the awakening mind. You found neither dhāraṇī nor meditative absorption. Noble sons, although you have entered rightly upon my awakening, in this good aeon, at the time of the last of the Tathāgatas to appear, you will attain forbearance with respect to the non-arising of phenomena. After that, beyond three incalculable aeons, you will fully and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, complete, and perfect awakening.

Noble sons, therefore, when those bodhisattvas see a bodhisattva, they should not think otherwise in their minds. They should think: 'We are seeing a stūpa, we are seeing a Tathāgata. A buddha is present before us.' Noble sons, if a bodhisattva sees a bodhisattva and gives rise to any perception other than the perception of a stūpa or the perception of a Tathāgata, that bodhisattva inflicts

a wound upon himself.

With this in mind, the Tathāgata Akṣobhya (the Unshakeable) took this solemn vow: 'If I see a bodhisattva who has first aroused the awakening mind and do not give rise to the perception of a buddha, may I thereby have deceived all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, dwelling in the innumerable world-systems.'

Noble sons, in the future, in the last five-hundred-year period, all those who come to obtain dhāraṇī or to obtain meditative absorption will obtain them through the power of the Tathāgata. Noble sons, therefore, whoever speaks ill of a Dharma-teacher in this context will have abandoned the Tathāgata. Noble sons, whoever teaches the Dharma of the Tathāgata to sentient beings in accordance with each being's own disposition — all of that is the power of the Tathāgata.

And in any assembly where those who follow the bodhisattva vehicle cause their hair to stand on end even a few times or shed tears even a few times while reading — all of that too should be understood as the power of the Tathāgata. Yet there are those foolish persons who, though not bodhisattvas themselves, claim to be bodhisattvas; who malign bodhisattvas; who steal the Dharma; who put on a false pretense; who act by bad ritual means. Some of them say things like: 'What does he know? What can such a one possibly understand?'

Maitreya, when I was practicing for the sake of awakening, the verses I purchased I purchased by giving up my own body entirely, by giving up my wife entirely, by giving up my sons and daughters entirely, by giving up my kingdom entirely. Maitreya, if I recollect that for the sake of a single well-spoken verse I gave away Jambudvīpa and purchased it — those people, while protecting gain and honor, do not think of approaching anyone equal to a buddha.

Ajita (the Unconquered One, Maitreya), the grasping of this mode of the holy Dharma belongs to those endowed with means, and not to those who lack them. Ajita, after I have fully and perfectly awakened, when I teach Dharma through the wisdom of a buddha, if those beings say of it, 'That should not be accepted as scripture,' — consider how great a serious fault those beings thereby incur, having gone to a wrong birth!

Ajita, a monk who, by means of that Dharma, teaches a thousand sūtras of analysis, and who cultivates the four meditative concentrations, yet comes to such a pass — what need is there to speak of one who merely makes contact

with a partial or proportional element of it, or who, having grasped analysis, is displeased with monks who hold to analysis and finds fault with analysis itself? Such beings denigrate Dharma-teaching monks, abandon the Dharma of the buddhas, and denigrate with great arrogance. That they are reborn in the hells — I do not call that well done. And why is that?"

Those who denigrate Dharma-teaching monks denigrate the buddhas; they denigrate the Dharma. Those who show no respect to Dharma-teaching monks show no respect to the buddhas. Those who speak ill of Dharma-teaching monks do not wish to see the buddhas; they speak ill of the buddhas. Those who generate a mind of anger toward a bodhisattva who has only just first aroused the awakening mind have thereby abandoned the buddhas, and they must be prepared to dwell in hell for as many eons as the moments of anger they generate. For as long as they look upon another with eyes of anger, they will be reborn in a blind sense base. For as long as they speak ill of another, they will be reborn without the sense base of a tongue.

Ajita, I do not see any other Dharma like this — where arousing a mind that harms bodhisattvas causes the bodhisattva themselves to fall, plunging downward to a lower destiny. Ajita, for those who abide in the perception of sentient beings and the perception of phenomena, there is the accumulation of karma; but for those who abide in non-apprehension, there is none.

Bodhisattvas who differentiate Dharma into separate divisions and teach it in that way abide in conceptual elaboration.

Ajita, since the perfect accomplishment of the six perfections by bodhisattvas is for the sake of awakening, those very foolish ones who say, "A bodhisattva need train only in the Perfection of Wisdom," and then disparage the remaining perfections — what can one say of them?

Ajita, what do you think? Is the king of Kāśīka who gave away his head an instance of mistaken wisdom?

He replied: "Blessed One, it is not."

The Blessed One declared: Ajita, the sūtras I have taught that are endowed with the six perfections — will they not lead to attaining awakening?

He replied: "Blessed One, they will lead to attaining awakening."

The Blessed One declared: Ajita, if you practice the perfection of generosity for sixty eons, practice the perfection of moral discipline for sixty eons, practice the perfection of patience for sixty eons, practice the perfection of diligence

for sixty eons, and practice the perfection of meditative concentration for sixty eons — and then those foolish ones say, "One attains awakening through the single method of non-apprehension alone" — they are of impure conduct. They are content with mere words and do not make accomplishment their core. They are diligent in the activity of speech but far from earnest effort. They have become jealous, they dwell in attachment, and they are troublesome to their kin.

Ajita, I myself did not attain the sovereignty of a wheel-turning king merely through being pleased at giving away my head. Yet those foolish ones, being miserly with material goods, go into the homes of others and say: "This is how one practises toward awakening. This is a bodhisattva's conduct; this is the proper way. Anything else is not the way. Most Dharma-teaching monks also know this rule of Dharma." They say such things, and out of that they generate much ill-will toward Dharma-teaching monks, all for the sake of gain and honor.

Ajita, for those people who make their living in this way, I would not say that even in a hundred eons would they attain even a compatible patience — let alone awakening. Ajita, for one endowed with deceitfulness there is no awakening. For the jealous there is none. For those who show no respect there is none. For those without right understanding there is none. For those who trouble households there is none. For those who engage in duplicity there is none.

Those foolish, unconquered ones boast that they are even wiser than I, and say that whatever teachings belong to the śrāvakas or to the pratyekabuddhas are teachings not spoken by the Tathāgata.

Then the Blessed One spoke to the venerable Subhūti. "Subhūti, the Perfection of Wisdom does indeed exist for one who practices non-duality." "Blessed One, it is so." "Subhūti, awakening does indeed exist for one who does not abide." "Blessed One, it is so." "Subhūti, awakening does indeed exist for one free of conceptual elaboration." "Blessed One, it is so."

"Subhūti, consider how much karmic maturation in the form of becoming impoverished those shameless ones — who are shameless because they harm their own kin — intend to fully take on. Furthermore, Ajita, a bodhisattva should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of the śrāvakas. A bodhisattva should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of the pratyekabuddhas. A bodhisattva should not be alarmed

thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of the buddhas, nor should one cling to that. A bodhisattva should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are not phenomena of the śrāvakas. A bodhisattva should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are not phenomena of the pratyekabuddhas. A bodhisattva should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are not phenomena of the buddhas, nor should one cling to that. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of ordinary beings. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are not phenomena of ordinary beings. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of affliction. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena free of affliction. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of purification. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without purification. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena with clinging. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without clinging. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are conditioned phenomena. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are unconditioned phenomena. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are new phenomena. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are not new phenomena. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of existence. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of non-existence. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of mind. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without mind. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of intention. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without intention. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of karma. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without karma. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of karmic maturation. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without karmic maturation. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of patience. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without patience. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of liberation. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without liberation. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of yoga. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena

are phenomena without yoga. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of the noble ones. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of those who are not noble. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of sentient beings. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without sentient beings.

One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of what is apprehended. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without anything to be apprehended. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of truth. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without truth. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of what is proper and fitting. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena without what is proper and fitting. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of what is stable. One should not be alarmed thinking that all phenomena are phenomena of what is unstable.

Invincible One, I became fully and perfectly awakened to the nature of reality at the seat of awakening, and though I know all objects of phenomena, it is not through an act of fixation. Though I know the essential nature of all phenomena, it is not through clinging to them that I teach the Dharma to the world. In order that bodhisattvas may obtain the luminous vision of phenomena and that dhāraṇīs and Dharma mudrās may arise in them, I have not disturbed suchness, have not removed phenomena, and have not constructed them.

Invincible One, when I teach the Dharma in this world-realm of the four great continents, from the Akaniṣṭha realm downward, sentient beings think: "The Tathāgata is teaching the Dharma to us alone." And likewise, extending this to the second set of four continents, and likewise throughout the great trichiliocosm: when I teach the Dharma in this great trichiliocosmic world-realm, sentient beings think: "The Tathāgata is teaching the Dharma to us alone. It is here that the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma. It is here that the Tathāgata was born. It is here that the wheel of Dharma was turned. Having turned the wheel of Dharma, he teaches the Dharma." Invincible One, by this skillful means I teach the Dharma in countless, boundless world-realms in the morning, and in this way I perform the deeds of a buddha. In the midday period as well I perform the deeds of a buddha in this way. In the evening period as well I perform the deeds of a buddha in this way, beholding all

phenomena, all sentient beings, and all world-realms with the unobstructed vision of the Tathāgata, and engaging in the seeing of wisdom and primordial wisdom. Thus, since the sphere of a buddha is inconceivable and immeasurable, those who abide in rejecting phenomena on this account say to bodhisattvas: "One should train in this; one should not train in that." Those who abide in rejecting phenomena in this way are abiding in slandering the buddhas. Those who abide in slandering the buddhas are, as it were, abiding on the ground of the abyss of the lower realms; they are abiding in a state that will lead them to be impoverished in Dharma.

Invincible One, therefore one should guard oneself in the Dharma taught through the skillful means of the Tathāgata.

Then Mañjuśrī, the Ever-Youthful, the bodhisattva Rightly Accomplished Heap of Wisdom, the bodhisattva Meaningful Vision, the bodhisattva Decisively Resolute Intelligence, the bodhisattva Intelligence Revealing the Supremely Decisive Mind, the bodhisattva Speaking with the Eloquence of Wisdom, the bodhisattva Fearless Perfect Illuminator, the bodhisattva King of Supreme Joy, the bodhisattva Dwelling Without Arrogance, the bodhisattva Contemplating the Rites of Boundless Buddha-Fields, the bodhisattva Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva Fragrant Elephant, the bodhisattva Woolen-Blanket Fragrant Elephant, the bodhisattva Sovereign Lord of Glorious Melody, the bodhisattva Dispeller of All Obscurations,

the bodhisattva Dwelling in Unrelenting Diligence, the bodhisattva Adorned with a Hundred Thousand Qualities, the bodhisattva Contemplating Omniscient Wisdom Without Confusion, the bodhisattva Victory Banner Cresting in Renowned Speech, the bodhisattva Benefiting All through the Dharma, the bodhisattva Dwelling Inseparable from the Domain of the Buddhas, the bodhisattva Subduing and Overpowering with the Splendor Adorned by Sandalwood, the bodhisattva Renowned and Revered by All the World.

These twenty bodhisattvas then addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, it is just so. Sugata, it is just so. We, too, have been to buddha-fields in the eastern direction as numerous as the grains of sand of sixty Ganges rivers, and in every one of them the Blessed One himself has turned the Dharma. Likewise, in world-systems in all ten directions it has been just the same: he has taught the Dharma to sentient beings. Blessed One, after we had traveled through buddha-fields for seven days without seeing any

other buddha, we returned here to hear the Dharma."

Then the Blessed One declared to Mañjuśrī, who appears as a youth: "Mañjuśrī, consider this: the domain and wisdom of the Tathāgata are immeasurable in this way. The domain of the buddhas is inconceivable in this way. Thus the Tathāgata, when measured by the Tathāgata's own qualities, is peerless and yet equal to the peerless. Mañjuśrī, with regard to this, those foolish people say: 'The conduct of the bodhisattvas in relation to the Tathāgata is the Perfection of Wisdom.' Mañjuśrī, the conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct beyond measure. The conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct without equal. The conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct without grasping. The conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct that does not abandon. The conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct that is steadfast in its pledges and completely pure in its superior intention. The conduct of a bodhisattva is conduct that never wearies in benefiting others. Mañjuśrī, if this kind of completely pure conduct of bodhisattvas is my Dharma, it will be difficult to behold at that time. Therefore, Mañjuśrī, all twenty of you noble ones must, by all means, take up the Dharma correctly and remain heedful, so that this teaching — in which I have genuinely accomplished awakening over measureless hundreds of thousands of aeons through skillful means — may become known to others. Be steadfast in your pledges. Keep your minds free from anger. Do not let sentient beings fall into the great abyss of abandoning the Dharma."

Then Mañjuśrī asked: "Blessed One, what is meant by abandoning the Dharma?"

The Blessed One replied: "Mañjuśrī, when someone perceives some among the discourses spoken by the Tathāgata as good and others as bad, that is abandoning the Dharma. One who abandons the Dharma in that way slanders the Tathāgata and speaks ill of the Saṅgha. If someone says, 'This is proper; this is improper,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'This was taught for the sake of bodhisattvas; this was taught for the sake of śrāvakas,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'This was taught for the sake of pratyekabuddhas,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'This is the training of a bodhisattva; this is not the training of a bodhisattva,' that is abandoning the Dharma."

If someone says, 'There is confidence here,' or 'There is no confidence here,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'The Dharma is being taught as what is not Dharma,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'One

can attain a dhāraṇī even without a buddha arising,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'The attainment of one who has attained a dhāraṇī is not perfectly pure,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'A teacher of Dharma is possessed of faulty conduct,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'The accomplishment of a teacher of Dharma is not excellent,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If one speaks with heedlessness, that is abandoning the Dharma. If one speaks by way of outward conduct alone, that is abandoning the Dharma. If one speaks while one's conduct and moral discipline are deteriorated, that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'One cannot understand through confidence,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'The teaching has not been well expounded,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'Through failure to comprehend, one statement has been made to contradict another,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'The words and letters enter the Tathāgata's speech,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'One sūtra has been made to contradict another sūtra,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'One verse has been made to contradict another verse,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'Some are devoted to a certain meaning, and some are not devoted to that meaning,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If one diverts the discourse to something else while the Dharma is being taught, that is abandoning the Dharma. If one creates confusion, that is abandoning the Dharma. If one speaks with total conceptuality, that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'This is to be practised; this is not to be practised,' that is abandoning the Dharma. If someone says, 'This is proper; this is not proper,' that is abandoning the Dharma.

Mañjuśrī, all the confidence that śrāvakas possess, however much it may be, and all the confidence that bodhisattvas possess, however much it may be — all of it is the power of the Tathāgata. Mañjuśrī, I have made the excellent aspiration that all the confidence possessed by śrāvakas, however much it may be, and all the confidence possessed by bodhisattvas, however much it may be, should arise from the power of the Tathāgata. Mañjuśrī, I have also made the excellent aspiration for awakening.

Now, those foolish people, roused by Māra to go to the lower realms, think to find fault even with that. They think to find fault even with those teachers of Dharma who are permitted by the Tathāgata to teach. They dwell guarding their households for the sake of gain, not for the sake of guarding the Tathāgata's teaching. Binding their lineage with a cord, they speak to

brahmins and householders thus: 'You have spoken well; you have rightly understood the Tathāgata's word' — and upon hearing one person speak but a single partial side of a matter, they rejoice in that as a basis. Because of their abandoning the Dharma in this way, they will be headed toward the great lower realms, going there in like manner.

Mañjuśrī, I do not say that clinging is the conduct of a bodhisattva. I do not say that a livelihood attached to home is perfectly pure. I do not say that those who teach in dualistic terms will be freed from poverty in the Dharma. I do not say that those who teach in terms of unity will be freed from the lower realms. I do not say that those who delight in talking are perfectly pure.

Mañjuśrī, I have taught as many gateways to the Dharma as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, doing so by way of non-apprehension. Mañjuśrī, I have not taught as many gateways to the Dharma as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā by way of apprehension. Mañjuśrī, I have taught those gateways to the Dharma — as many as there are grains of sand in the Gaṅgā — to those devoted to emptiness. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by perceiving sentient beings as such. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of the signless.

I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of conceptuality. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of the wishless. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of the wished-for. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of the personal. I have taught that many gateways to the Dharma by way of the impersonal. I have taught that many by way of engagement and that many by way of withdrawal; that many by way of existence and that many by way of non-existence; that many by way of the conditioned and that many by way of the unconditioned; that many by way of the direct and that many by way of the indirect; that many by way of the concealed and that many by way of the unconcealed; that many gateways to the Dharma by way of saṃsāra and that many by way of nirvāṇa; that many pertaining to the world and that many pertaining to what transcends the world; that many gateways by way of attachment, that many by way of aversion, and that many by way of delusion. Mañjuśrī, I have taught as many gateways to the Dharma as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā — as many gateways to the Dharma that are gateways of abandonment.

Mañjuśrī, all of this is as follows: if one understands the Perfection of Wisdom only in terms of impermanence, understanding thereby but one side of one direction, one slanders the Tathāgata.

Then the young Mañjuśrī addressed the Blessed One with these words: Blessed One, if someone, through the influence of an evil companion, were to commit such an act of abandoning the Dharma in this way, how might that person be liberated in this very lifetime?

When this was said, the Blessed One spoke thus to the young Mañjuśrī: Mañjuśrī, if for seven years, confessing each and every transgression once a day at each of the three times of day, one confesses one's transgressions, one will be purified thereafter, and from that point on, one will attain patience within as few as ten eons. Mañjuśrī, if a son or daughter of good family who belongs to the lineage of the bodhisattva vehicle were to teach this enumeration of the Dharma without having received and read it, it goes without saying that liberation would be extremely difficult — they would be impoverished in the Dharma. Therefore, a bodhisattva should first train in this and only afterward teach the Dharma. In that way, they will not fall into such impoverishment.

Mañjuśrī, a bodhisattva should thoroughly internalize the four equalities. What are the four? The equality of sentient beings, the equality of phenomena, the equality of awakening, and the equality of insight. These four equalities are what a bodhisattva should thoroughly internalize. If one teaches without having thoroughly internalized these four equalities, whatever one says will amount to speaking about a self.

Furthermore, if a bodhisattva, a great being — a son or daughter of good family — is endowed with four qualities, they will be liberated without falling into impoverishment. What are the four? A mind free from anger toward all sentient beings; not contradicting those who, with understanding and conviction, teach the Dharma; not abandoning others; and reverence for all that the Tathāgata has spoken. If a son or daughter of good family is endowed with these four qualities, they will be liberated without falling into impoverishment.

Mañjuśrī, the merit generated by a bodhisattva who adorns all buddha-fields with the seven precious substances for as many eons as there are grains of sand in the river Gaṅgā, and who each day offers those gifts to buddhas, the Blessed Ones, as numerous as grains of sand in the Gaṅgā — that merit is

surpassed by the merit generated by one who writes out this enumeration of the Dharma belonging to the sūtra that comprises all thorough analysis, makes it into a book, and reads it even just three times. Why is this so?

There is no generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration, or wisdom equal in its mass of merit to training in this sūtra that comprises all thorough analysis. When this enumeration of the Dharma is taught, any bodhisattva present will attain acceptance of the non-arising of phenomena equal in number to the grains of sand in thirty rivers Gaṅgā. Any bodhisattva present will become irreversible from unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening, in number equal to the grains of sand in seventy rivers Gaṅgā. The sixty billion trillion sentient beings of this great trichiliocosm who rejoice in this enumeration of the Dharma and don the great armor for awakening will all revolve through saṃsāra for eighty eons, and at the end of those eighty eons they will all completely and perfectly awaken to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. If bodhisattvas diligently put it into practice, this enumeration of the Dharma is thus of great meaning, of great fruit, of great benefit, greatly luminous, and greatly vast.

Therefore, Mañjuśrī, you should train in this enumeration of the Dharma and, in the future age, uphold the Dharma. In this way you will be liberated without delay.

Then those twenty Dharma-speakers addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, lord of the Dharma, king of the Dharma — just as the Blessed One has declared, so shall we act. Through the power of the buddhas and through the blessing of the buddhas, we shall excellently carry out the words of the Tathāgata."

After the Blessed One had spoken these words, the youthful Mañjuśrī, those great bodhisattvas, those monks, and the world with its gods, humans, asuras, and gandharvas rejoiced and praised what the Blessed One had taught.

The noble Mahāyāna sūtra entitled "The Sūtra Comprising All Thorough Analysis" is hereby complete.

Translated by the Indian preceptors Jinamitra and Munivarma, and the great editor-translator the monk Ye shes sde. Edited and finalized.

Translator's Notes

- The title term rendered "Compendium of All Knowledge" translates the Sanskrit Sarva Vidyā Samgraha. The Tibetan བསྟན་འཛིན་ཀློང་གྲུབ་ literally means "complete weaving together" or

"complete gathering," and the Sanskrit vidyā can mean "knowledge," "science," or "spell/dhāraṇī." The title could therefore alternatively be read as "Compendium of All Dhāraṇīs." Given the sūtra's apparent content, "knowledge" or "sciences" is the most defensible general rendering, but the ambiguity is genuine.

The phrase समस्तसंसारोपरि, rendered "the summit of existence," refers technically to the highest plane of the formless realm, the apex of conditioned samsāric existence.

- The title of the sūtra being referenced here is rendered as "The Compendium of All Weavings." The Tibetan term "rnam par 'thag pa thams cad bsdus pa" is somewhat rare and the image of "weaving" (rnam par 'thag pa) in a doctrinal title is uncommon; it may alternatively connote a kind of comprehensive doctrinal synthesis or compilation. The choice of "compendium" for "bsdus pa" is standard, but "weavings" for "rnam par 'thag pa" is an attempt to render the literal sense. No Sanskrit equivalent is recoverable from context alone to clarify further.
- The passage ends mid-sentence in the source, as the Tibetan itself continues beyond what was provided. The translation preserves this open ending faithfully.

The term rendered "wild and arrogant" for 野蠻驕慢 is a compound meaning literally "wild" or "untamed and fierce" — sometimes glossed as audacious or recklessly presumptuous. The rendering captures the sense of those who falsely swagger in the bodhisattva role.

- The phrase rendered "my two awakenings" translates *byang chub gnyis*, which likely refers to the distinction between the two types of *bodhicitta*, or possibly the two aspects of awakening. The precise referent is somewhat opaque from context alone, and commentarial clarification would be needed for certainty.

The expression rnam par 'thag pa, rendered here as "the weaving," is a specific text or genre title recurring throughout the passage. It may refer to a particular sūtra or collection whose Sanskrit title has not been preserved in this fragment. Its translation as "the weaving" follows the literal Tibetan.

- The name "Ajita" (meaning "the Unconquered One") is the bodhisattva addressed throughout this passage, a common epithet for Maitreya. The passage addresses him as "mi pham pa," which literally means "the Unconquered," and I have rendered it as "Ajita" consistently.

The Tathāgata "kun nas spos rin po che'i 'od" is rendered as "Pervading with the Light of Precious Fragrance," which is a literal translation of the Tibetan; the Sanskrit equivalent is not entirely certain.

The final sentence is incomplete as given and runs directly into the next passage.

- The name Maitreya appears here both under the form "Byams pa" (Maitreya, lit. "Loving-kindness") and "Mi pham pa" (Ajita, lit. "the Unconquered"), both being standard epithets of the bodhisattva Maitreya in this literature. The translation renders each by its corresponding epithet with Maitreya as the base name, using "Ajita" for Mi pham pa on the grounds that distinguishing the two forms enriches the address. This is a standard identification in the commentarial tradition.

The phrase rendered "forbearance with respect to the non-arising of phenomena" is the standard Tibetan for anutpattikadharmaṁśānti, the bodhisattva's patient acceptance of the unborn nature of all phenomena, a key milestone on the bodhisattva path.

The closing rhetorical question "And why is that?" signals that the discourse continues beyond this passage.

- The phrase rendered "compatible patience" translates a term that in Mahāyāna path-literature refers to an early level of patient acceptance on the path, sometimes glossed as

"concordant patience" or "acquiescent tolerance" — a far cry from the higher realizations, which makes the rhetorical force of the sentence clear. The expression "trouble households" refers to creating discord and strife within lay families, typically by soliciting material support through flattery or by sowing division.

- The passage contains an abrupt shift in the interlocutor name mid-section: the exchange with Subhūti appears to interrupt what is elsewhere addressed to Ajita. The Tibetan text itself makes this transition without explanation, and the resumption of "Ajita" in the second main block follows directly from the preceding passage in the continuity. This may reflect a textual dislocation or composite redaction in the source; it has been rendered faithfully as it stands.

The phrase rendered "phenomena of intention" translates རྒྱུ་ཤེས་ (cetanā, mental volition) as distinct from རྒྱུ་ཤེས་ (citta, mind), and this distinction has been preserved in the translation.

- The passage about sentient beings in different world-realms each thinking the Tathāgata teaches "only to us" is a standard teaching on the Tathāgata's simultaneous, omnipresent activity; the Tibetan constructs this by analogy, extending from a single four-continent world-system upward to the great trichilocosm.

The bodhisattva names in the closing list are proper names requiring contextual rendering.

"Fragrant Elephant" (Skt. Gandhastī) and "Woolen-Blanket Fragrant Elephant" (Skt. Pañjikā-Gandhastī or similar) are attested bodhisattva names in Mahāyāna sūtra literature; the precise Sanskrit equivalents of the less common names in this list cannot be determined with certainty from the Tibetan alone.

- The phrase rendering the Tathāgata as "peerless and yet equal to the peerless" reflects the Tibetan "mi mnyam pa dang mnyam," literally "equal in being without equal," a standard paradoxical formula for the Buddha's incomparability; the rendering tries to capture that philosophical tension without over-smoothing it.

The twenty bodhisattvas' report of traveling for seven days without seeing another buddha is a notable doctrinal claim about the boundlessness of Śākyamuni's buddha-field, worth flagging as theologically significant in context.

- The phrase rendered "binding their lineage with a cord" translates "rigs la gdu bas," which is somewhat obscure. It likely refers to monks or teachers who exploit their caste or family connections to curry favor with brahmins and householders — using social ties as a tool for material gain. The image may be of tethering or fettering themselves to worldly lineage. This is a consequentially difficult phrase and the rendering is interpretive.

The passage on teaching "as many gateways to the Dharma as grains of sand in the Gaṅgā" by way of non-apprehension versus apprehension reflects a key Mahāyāna distinction: the Buddha's ultimate mode of teaching is non-referential and non-conceptual, not pointing to fixed objects; the gateways taught to those devoted to emptiness are given precisely through a non-objectifying approach.

- The phrase rendered "gateways of abandonment" translates spon ba'i sgo, meaning gateways concerned with relinquishing or letting go — a technical reference to practices of abandonment as a path-category. The rendering preserves this sense while keeping the flow of the list.

The phrase rendered "teaching only one side of one direction" translates phyogs kyi yang phyogs gcig, literally "even one direction of a direction," conveying the idea of a partial, one-sided grasp of the Perfection of Wisdom reduced solely to impermanence, which misrepresents its full scope and thereby constitutes a slander of the Tathāgata.

- The phrase "without delay" renders the Tibetan literally meaning "without being told" or "spontaneously," conveying that liberation will come of its own accord without further

prompting — a standard soteriological idiom in this context.

The numeral "sixty billion trillion" renders the Tibetan "bye ba khrag khrig brgya stong phrag drug cu," a large cosmological number combining units of ten million, one hundred billion, and sixty; the precise value is conventional rather than mathematically fixed in the tradition.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.